

Edward Taylor

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I bring clarity to complex problems by clarifying ambiguous customer needs, aligning with business requirements and implementing with solid engineering fundamentals that simplify ongoing maintenance.

I thrive in fast-moving environments where wearing multiple hats — architecting, scoping, exploring, managing, or ideating — is part of getting great products shipped.

Skills

Software

- Backend (AWS, Rust in lambda, Postgres)
- Apps (Flutter, Android, iOS, Web)
- Linux (systemd, nixos, Raspberry Pi)
- C#, Go, Dart, Javascript, Kotlin, Python
- React (vite, Redux, flutter, deck.gl)

Process

- Balances multiple priorities and projects
- Translates stakeholder needs into technical requirements
- Explores the future while developing the present and maintaining the past
- Upholds quality with SDLC, isolation, impact and risk analysis

Product

- User interviewing and feedback collation
- Deep care and intuition for customer experience
- Passion for converting ambiguity into clarity through collaborative process
- Leveraging agents for tighter feedback loops

Recent Experience

Starboard Maritime Intelligence

Senior Software Engineer | June 2025 - Today

I was attracted to Starboard for their ability to leverage realtime data at high volumes and funnel it into an intuitive UX. I expanded my capabilities in this role to step towards staff engineer responsibilities, championing the customer's experience, and aligning engineering efforts with the business and product needs.

Frontend owner

Within a few months of joining, I took over as owner of the frontend when the outgoing maintainer departed. The hardest part of this role was pushing forwards with Typescript and linting improvements in a pre-typescript codebase that was stuck inside a Create-React-App template which had ballooned to 100s of components. My greatest achievements include initiating new standards, such as co-located feature folders, that could be iteratively adopted and moving development to vite to improve the dev experience.

I explored the potential of using deck.gl and geospatial cloud formats to enable more performant and flexible experiences, without impacting the feature roadmap.

Agentic development

I worked at Starboard during the AI takeoff of early 2026, and I've been deeply involved with tooling improvements and process/leadership discussions to ensure we leverage it best in our specific context. I believe that agentic development isn't something to be avoided and there is still deep meaningful work for humans to carry out both at a high architectural level, at maintaining a quality of code that results in great output and in shaping the agentic processes based on the business need.

Engineering process

I worked alongside a Principal engineer to take their heavyweight SDLC process and roll out a lightweight version of it inside Fibery, which the Product and Engineering team now utilise.

I initiated new PR review processes to reduce feedback time, and was consistently one of the most active reviewers and encouraged discussions around the organisation to reach consensus on issues that were apparent. Nominated for a company award for "When faced with uncertainty, he leans in, listens to people and searches for ways to have impact".

Delivering value

With the help of a strong team beside me and a knowledgeable PM, I lead the implementation of the Asset Catalog - a feature to allow Critical Maritime Industry (CMI) customers to visualise their maritime assets. I used standards such as [GeoJSON](#), [simplestyle](#) and [protobufs](#) to improve usability, something I found lacking in the existing codebase. This Beta feature was quickly expanded to more customers, some outside the CMI domain as they wanted access to the underlying functionality.

Product Engineering

I consider myself a mix between Product and Engineering. I care a lot about understanding the customer, their needs, our impact and how we can find a path to more value. I find the UX impact and alignment with the vision just as important as technical implementations. At Starboard, I aligned with the Product team's use of Fibery to explore the product. I helped by implementing changes inside Fibery to bring engineers closer to the Product team, encouraging discussions such as requirement gathering.

I explored thin vertical feature slices for early feature ideation and produced overviews in Fibery which helped Product to understand, prioritise and estimate different changes. I believe agentic development makes this ideation output and product collaboration more valuable than ever.

Customer experience and feedback is key to building any great product. I always seek the customer impact behind a change, even when reviewing PRs.

Smart Access

Lead Developer | Mar 2023 - 2026

At Smart Access, I lead the transformation from a white-label prototype to a production-grade cross-platform mapping system, architecting a scalable backend with Rust and AWS and a utilitarian interface in Flutter. The company had accumulated valuable accessibility data over years of collection, and I designed a comprehensive platform to maximize and expand this data asset. Under my leadership, we successfully expanded the company across multiple strategic directions:

Smart Access Navigation ([Web](#))

I drove the reimplementing of the mapping app in Flutter to enable cross-platform compatibility and accelerate the development cycle. Starting with a functional clone of the Android app for accessibility data visualization, I quickly expanded it to incorporate ambitious features. To enable remote map data updates, I engineered a backend in AWS utilizing PostGIS and a Rust web server in lambda to efficiently serve requests to our frontends.

Working closely with the founder to define strategic direction, I designed and implemented an experimental Navigation System - successfully integrating our proprietary data with Open Street Maps through Python GeoPandas and NetworkX to create a comprehensive sidewalk graph. This graph is imported to our Postgres backend where routing is calculated using pgRouting alongside a patented algorithm I implemented for custom weighting.

Tagging/Annotation app

We identified automation as key to the future of mapping data. Based on this vision, I created an internal app for building a dataset of geometrically annotated aerial imagery, leveraging New Zealand's LINZ open-source aerial imagery resources. I designed a streamlined UX for various annotation workflows, incorporating powerful data import capabilities from our other products.

Access Quest ([Web](#))

Accelerated data collection through a hardware integrated app that dramatically improved both speed and accuracy of in-field data collection. I created an intuitive interface with optimized UX that seamlessly integrates with our unified backend.

Summary

I mastered advanced techniques while working with Smart Access - implementing workflows for local database testing, developing shared flutter libraries between apps, establishing automatic deployment pipelines, and more recently, pioneering feature prototyping with AI tools.

The Smart Access platform now operates as a comprehensive data pipeline, efficiently moving information from users and clients in the field to people with disabilities through the map app, with sophisticated data annotation and intelligence in the backend.

History

My Life My Voice Feb 2023 - 2025

Peer support communication platform

- Live chat flutter app
- User customisation and auth
- Accessible user experience

TASKA Prosthetics Nov 2019 - Nov 2020

Mobile Developer for hand management app

- Integrating with a larger team
- Multi platform development
- Legacy software migration

Victoria University Nov 2018 - Oct 2019

Alexa App and Class Tutor

- Developed accessible voice interfaces
- Designed alternative interaction models
- Mentored students in technical skills

Savesign Nov 2017 - Dec 2019

Display CMS for Raspberry Pi

- Built robust Java applications
- Configured Linux systems for reliability
- Developed embedded display solutions

GeneralApps Apr 2016 - Jan 2017

Android app development

- Client negotiation
- App development
- Live audio programming

Education

Victoria University of Wellington 2017 - 2019

Bachelor of Design Innovation (Media Design)

- Deans Award
- 7.32 GPA [Download Transcript](#)

Canterbury University 2014 - 2016

Bachelor of Science (Computer Science) [Incomplete]

First year completed with average of A-
Changed second year to pursue applied skills